



Poison ivy has shiny leaves.

Plants to avoid

In North American forests, simply brushing against vines, such as poison ivy and poison oak, brings many people out in an itchy rash. In any forest, look out for stinging plants such as nettles, and plants with barbs or briars, such as wild roses. Never touch or eat any berries since they can be poisonous.



Close encounters

Most animals will avoid humans if they hear you approach, but you may be lucky enough to see some up close. If you do, stay still and give them room and time to move away. Never run from a larger animal such as a bear. It may end up chasing you!

Respect snakes

Many snakes are harmless, and most simply want to avoid humans, but you may come across one on a walk that refuses to move. Keep away and walk around it if necessary, while admiring it from a safe distance.

